



JUN 24-25, 2026

HEMIS GOMPA CULTURAL FESTIVAL

VENUE HEMIS MONASTERY, LADAKH
TICKETS AT THE VENUE

The Hemis Gompa Cultural Festival is among Ladakh's most significant annual observances, held at Hemis Monastery (45 km from Leh), founded in 1672. Celebrated uninterrupted since around 1730, the festival commemorates the birth of Guru Padmasambhava, revered as the presiding figure of Tibetan Buddhism. Central to the two-day festival is the Chham, or masked dance-drama, performed by monks in elaborate costumes and ritual masks, symbolising the triumph of good over evil and the protection of Buddha Dharma. Alongside sacred performances, the festival features Ladakhi handicrafts, jewellery, textiles, paintings, and indigenous artefacts, offering a vivid expression of the region's spiritual and artistic heritage.



DEC 1-10, 2026

HORNBILL FESTIVAL

VENUE KISAMA HERITAGE VILLAGE, KOHIMA, NAGALAND

TICKETS AT THE VENUE, NAGALAND TOURISM WEBSITE

Conceptualised in 2000, the Hornbill Festival is a ten-day annual celebration organised by the Government of Nagaland to showcase the region's rich tribal heritage. Often called the "Festival of Festivals," it brings together diverse cultures of the Naga tribes at a single venue, while also hosting participants from across Northeast India. Named after the hornbill, a bird central to Naga folklore, the festival promotes inter-tribal exchange through music, dance, sport, craft, and cuisine. Held at Kisama Heritage Village, near Kohima, highlights include traditional performances, tribal *morungs* (traditional Naga youth dormitories), indigenous games, handcrafted textiles and jewellery, and a vibrant showcase of Naga culinary traditions. **BT**

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